Summer 2026 Substitute Player Process

Updated 3/9/26

The purpose of the Substitute Player Process is to allow teams to replace injured or unavailable players which will help them maintain competitive integrity while preventing them from gaining an unfair advantage through the selection of subs. A team should be at its most competitive point with their original drafted players. Specific rules governing the substitution process can also be found in Division 1 Rules.

“Sub-Only” players will be finalized after the draft. No player will be allowed to sign up as a SUB–ONLY player after the deadline to apply to play in Division 1 each season, other than a player coming to Division 1 out of evaluations. As guidance, players who have registered as a Sub-Only player should have preference over rostered players when a sub is needed, and managers are expected to use a Sub-Only player whenever possible.

The Sub Coordinator has the authority to lower (i.e. more skilled) the rating of any player that is consistently playing significantly “above” other players drafted in the same round. For a drafted player, the revised rating shall only apply to that player when asked to substitute. The rating of a drafted player may not be increased (i.e. less skilled) but could be increased for a SUB-ONLY player after board approval.

Sub-Only players and team managers should use The Villages Softball Division 1 Sub Player Coordination website at http://sites.google.com/view.tvd1subs to facilitate the sub player process.

Sub-Only players should regularly check their availability on the website and submit requests as needed to update it whenever their schedule changes. Requests for changes should be submitted via the website.

Team managers should review the website regularly to ensure it accurately reflects the status of their substitute players. Requests for changes should be submitted via the website. Team managers are also expected to Verify Subs on the website the day before each game after confirming that the Game Day Summary accurately lists their substitutes for the next day.

NOTE: It is the responsibility of each team manager to submit a timely request for any Game Day Substitute player changes. Once a substitute player has been reflected on the website for a team more than 24 hours following the game in which they were a substitute, that substitution will become permanent and may not be modified.

Regular Season

LEAGUE SUBSTITUTION GUIDE

Player Being Replaced	Who Can Substitute
Round 1 Player	Any drafted or Sub-Only player
Round 2 Player	Any player drafted round 2-11 or Sub-Only player rated 2-11
Round 3 Player	Any player drafted round 3–11 or Sub-Only player rated 3-11
Round 4–5 Player	Any player drafted round 4–11 or Sub-Only player rated 4-11
Round 6–7 Player	Any player drafted round 6–11 or Sub-Only player rated 6-11
Round 8–9 Player	Any player drafted round 8–11 or Sub-Only player rated 8-11
Round 10–11 Player	Any player drafted round 10–11 or Sub-Only player rated 10-11

Substitution Limits

Players drafted in rounds 1-9 and Sub-Only players rated 1-9 may only substitute up to 2 times per team during the regular season.

Players drafted in rounds 10–11 and Sub-Only players rated 10-11 may substitute for any team unlimited times.

Game Day Substitute Players

After the 1st pitch has been thrown, a rostered player which has been replaced CANNOT enter the game if a substitute player has been obtained. In the event a substitute player enters the game before the player to be replaced has had 1 complete at bat, and played 3 outs in the field, that substitute shall be counted as a substitute player used by that team. A substitute entering the game after this point will not be counted against the teams substitutes use. The manager must submit a sub request for any qualifying game day substitutes to the Sub Coordinator before the end of the day.

If a manager is found to be abusing the "Game Day Substitute Players" rules, the Sub Coordinator may impose a penalty where their team will be required to use a player from the next lowest category for "ALL" of their substitute players the next game any substitute is utilized.

Post Season

The following will apply only to the Post-Season Playoffs.

1. Sub-Only players are not available for use.

2. For players drafted in rounds 1 – 9, a substitute must come from at least one round later.

For Example:

Player Being Replaced	Who Can Substitute
Round 1 Player	Player drafted round 2+
Round 2 Player	Player drafted round 3+
Round 3 Player	Player drafted round 4+

3. Rounds 10 & 11 players can substitute for anyone.

4. No player shall play for a team more than once as a substitute player throughout the playoffs.

5. No player shall play for 2 different teams on the same day as a Substitute Player.